

DAEMONCORE

FieldOps Operator Fieldbook

A practical desk and field reference for authorized assessment, evidence, resilience, and closeout work.

RELEASE 6.5.1

Windows and Linux edition
DaemonCore Apps
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CONTROLLED PROFESSIONAL USE

A license unlocks FieldOps. It does not authorize a target. Work only under valid written authorization, exact scope, an active testing window, and an agreed stop procedure.

The rule that keeps every action defensible

FieldOps is most useful when the operator treats authorization, execution, evidence, and reporting as one continuous chain. The goal is not maximum activity. The goal is the smallest reliable proof that answers the approved question.

- **Know the proof point.** Write the condition that will end the test before execution starts.
- **Pin the destination.** Confirm the target, resolved address, port, protocol, and path against the signed permit.
- **Measure before pressure.** Capture a clean baseline and confirm target-side monitoring before a load profile.
- **Stop on uncertainty.** Treat DNS drift, unexpected ownership, telemetry loss, or a scope mismatch as a stop condition.
- **Seal as you go.** Promote useful captures while context is fresh; do not reconstruct the evidence chain later.

Five questions before Run

QUESTION	REQUIRED ANSWER
Authority	Who approved this exact action?
Boundary	Which target, address, port, path, and time window apply?
Objective	What observation proves or disproves the condition?
Control	Who can stop the activity and how will recovery be verified?
Evidence	What must be preserved for another reviewer to reproduce the conclusion?

From zero to a defensible first capture

- 1 Verify** the release checksum, launch on a dedicated operator account, and confirm version 6.5.1.
- 2 Activate** FieldOps Pro and confirm secure credential storage is available.
- 3 Bind** the named operator identity and review the displayed organization and email.
- 4 Declare** the engagement from the written rules of engagement, using exact targets and ports.
- 5 Baseline** with DNS, TCP, HTTP, TLS, or Complete Target Baseline before broader activity.
- 6 Seal** material captures, create evidence-backed findings, and export the case file before closeout.

Fast workstation checks

Windows: `Get-FileHash .\DaemonCore-Academy-Setup.exe -Algorithm SHA256`

Linux: `sha256sum ./DaemonCore-Academy-*.AppImage`

Tools: `docker version` `nmap --version` `k6 version`

Operator note. Tip. Capture the tool version output in the case notes. It explains capability differences and makes later reproduction easier.

The sixty second go or no go

CHECK	GO CONDITION
Identity	Correct named operator and protected device key
Permit	Signature valid; status active; policy permits the action
Time	Current time is inside the approved window
Destination	Exact target and port are listed; network mode matches
Resolution	Resolved addresses remain inside the declared boundary
Dependencies	Required Docker, Nmap, or k6 adapter reports ready
Observers	Owner, approver, and recovery contact know the start time
Abort	Local stop and target-side stop have named owners
Evidence	Clock, monitoring, log retention, and export location are ready

Decision. No go means no improvisation. Correct the permit or environment, preserve the blocked event, and begin again from preflight.

Choose the workspace by the question

WORKSPACE	USE IT WHEN YOU NEED
Diagnostics	One focused DNS, TCP, HTTP, TLS, service, inventory, or surface answer
Execution Fabric	Native tool readiness, managed Nmap, verified k6, scope export, or evidence intake
Campaigns	Repeatable approved checks across several declared targets
Assets and evidence	Service history, change intelligence, capture integrity, and promotion
Findings	Impact, severity, remediation, disposition, and retest history
Chaos Engine	A short bounded resilience sample with automatic SLO aborts

Navigation trick

Begin in the Engagement Vault, confirm the scope strip, then choose the workspace. Return to Assets and Evidence after every meaningful operation. That rhythm prevents unreviewed output from piling up.

Select the least invasive useful operation

NEED	START WITH	ESCALATE TO
Name and address truth	DNS resolution	DNS record profile
One service reachable	TCP reachability	Service profile
Web control posture	HTTP response	HTTP security posture
Certificate identity	TLS identity	Service profile
Declared ports	Allowed port survey	Deep service inventory
Change over time	Complete target baseline	Repeat baseline and review drift
Known control paths	Bounded web map	External approved specialist evidence

Evidence rule. A service fingerprint is a lead, not a finding. Confirm the observed behavior, environmental context, prerequisites, and business effect before assigning severity.

Make the permit operational

- **Targets.** Use exact hostnames or IP addresses. Separate internal and external boundaries.
- **Ports.** List only the ports authorized for this engagement; do not use a remembered standard list.
- **Window.** Include timezone, maintenance exclusions, and the latest permitted stop time.
- **Approver.** Record a named authority, professional email, and authorization reference that another reviewer can retrieve.
- **Policy.** Use Observe for focused collection, Validate for broader assessment, and Stress only for explicitly approved resilience work.
- **Capacity.** Professional mode signs the declared target and port lists as capacity; target-hosted grants separately govern managed load.

Amend instead of stretching

A new hostname, port, path, technique, date, or approving authority is a scope change. Close or supersede the permit and issue a new one. Never reinterpret an old permit during execution.

Use native tools without losing the chain

- **Rescan capabilities.** Do this after installing Docker, Nmap, or k6, and after changing PATH.
- **Prefer managed execution.** When available, let FieldOps pin arguments, record versions, stream output, and seal the result.
- **Use signed scope export.** For a specialist tool, export the declared boundary and preserve the manifest with the tool output.
- **Import structured evidence.** Use supported JSON or SARIF and bind it to the exact engagement target.
- **Preserve originals.** Keep the raw source artifact beside the FieldOps case export and record its SHA-256 digest.

Dependency triage

STATE	FIRST ACTION
Docker unavailable	Start Docker Engine or Desktop; verify daemon access
Nmap unavailable	Install Nmap or use the supported Docker adapter
k6 unavailable	Install Grafana k6; restart FieldOps; rescan capabilities
Tool starts then stops	Review timeout, permit window, target pin, and local process output

Managed k6 launch sequence

- 1 Baseline.** Capture steady-state latency, error rate, saturation, and recovery behavior.
- 2 Publish.** Have the system owner place the challenge-bound capacity grant on the exact trusted TLS target.
- 3 Verify.** Confirm target, authorization reference, challenge, expiration, and signature-bound grant fields.
- 4 Configure.** Choose the approved baseline, ramp, spike, soak, breakpoint, or recovery profile within the grant.
- 5 Observe.** Keep application, infrastructure, dependency, queue, and user-impact telemetry visible.
- 6 Execute.** Arm managed k6 only after both local and target-side stop owners are ready.
- 7 Recover.** Continue observation after traffic ends until agreed recovery indicators return to baseline.
- 8 Seal.** Preserve the permit, grant, workload plan, engine version, telemetry summary, stop reason, and result digest.

Hard rule. The verified grant is the capacity contract. If the intended rate, concurrency, duration, or expiration exceeds it, obtain a new grant rather than splitting the run.

Read the system while pressure is active

SIGNAL	INTERPRETATION	ACTION
Achieved RPS	Delivery versus requested rate	Check dropped iterations and client limits
P95 latency	Tail response under load	Compare with SLO and baseline
Error rate	Failed user-facing work	Stop at approved abort threshold
Saturation	CPU, memory, pools, queues	Find the first constrained dependency
Dropped iterations	Generator could not maintain schedule	Separate generator limits from target limits
Recovery time	Return to steady state	Do not declare success at traffic stop

Use the emergency stop when

- The permit, grant, target identity, monitoring view, or communications path becomes uncertain.
- An agreed SLO, infrastructure threshold, user-impact threshold, or business stop condition is reached.
- The workload deviates from the signed plan or the target-side owner calls stop.

Build a record another operator can trust

PRESERVE	WHY IT MATTERS
Permit and grant	Proves the declared authority and capacity context
Target and resolution	Shows where execution was actually pinned
Tool and version	Supports repeatability and explains parser behavior
Raw capture	Retains the original observation before interpretation
Timestamps and timezone	Aligns endpoint, target, and monitoring events
Digest and receipt	Detects later change and binds the operation record
Operator notes	Separates observation, inference, decision, and limitation

Write observations in present tense and inferences as conclusions supported by named evidence. If evidence is incomplete, state the limitation instead of filling the gap.

Minimal note pattern

OBSERVED: <fact> SOURCE: <capture> AT: <time>
INFERRED: <meaning> LIMIT: <uncertainty> NEXT: <retest>

Turn captures into decisions

- **Title.** Name the failed control or exposed condition, not the scanner signature.
- **Evidence.** Attach the smallest capture set that proves the condition and preserves context.
- **Impact.** Describe the credible business or security consequence under observed prerequisites.
- **Severity.** Account for exposure, asset role, data sensitivity, controls, detection, and recovery.
- **Remediation.** Recommend a control outcome, owner, and validation step rather than a generic patch phrase.
- **Retest.** Repeat the minimum proof, confirm intended behavior still works, and attach a new sealed capture.

Status discipline

STATE	USE WHEN
Open	The condition is validated and awaits action
Accepted	Authorized risk owner accepts the documented residual risk
Remediated	A change is reported but still needs independent retest
Closed	Retest evidence supports closure

Scale repetition without losing control

- **Use one objective.** A campaign should answer one repeatable question across the selected targets.
- **Order low to high.** Resolve and baseline first; inventory or deeper validation follows only when needed.
- **Watch task state.** Pause on systematic failure instead of allowing bad assumptions to multiply.
- **Resume deliberately.** After restart recovery, confirm the permit window and target state before resuming pending tasks.
- **Review outliers.** A single different result may be the most important campaign outcome.

Campaign stop conditions

Repeated DNS drift, widespread timeouts, unexpected rate limiting, authentication prompts, owner stop request, or evidence-integrity failure should pause the campaign for human review.

Recover the workflow without guessing

SYMPTOM	CHECK FIRST	NEXT MOVE
Operation blocked	Permit status, policy, target, port, time	Correct scope; preserve blocked event
Wrong boundary	DNS answers and Internal or External mode	Stop; obtain a scope decision
No native adapter	PATH, process restart, capability rescan	Install supported tool or use evidence bridge
Capacity rejected	Challenge, TLS, target, grant expiry and fields	Republish the exact grant
Load will not arm	Stress policy, verified grant, k6 availability	Resolve the failed preflight item
Evidence rejected	Format, size, exact target, source digest	Re-export structured JSON or SARIF
Integrity failed	Original artifact and last known export	Stop relying on record; escalate review
License offline	Last validation and grace deadline	Restore connectivity and validate

When professional judgment overrides momentum

- A hostname resolves outside the approved boundary or changes ownership during the window.
- The target-side owner cannot see the activity, cannot stop it, or loses monitoring.
- Production health degrades beyond the agreed threshold or dependent services show collateral impact.
- The app reports permit, signature, grant, evidence, or secure-storage integrity failure.
- A technique requires credentials, destructive changes, persistence, data access, or exploitation not named in the rules of engagement.
- The operator cannot distinguish a target failure from a generator, network, or observation failure.

Stop record

TIME / OPERATOR / RUN ID / STOP SOURCE / OBSERVED CONDITION
LOCAL ACTION / TARGET ACTION / RECOVERY OWNER / RECOVERY PROOF

Leave the client with a usable record

- **Freeze execution.** Stop active jobs, confirm recovery, and close the authorization boundary when work ends.
- **Verify integrity.** Review capture digests, signed receipts, audit state, and imported evidence provenance.
- **Reconcile findings.** Every material observation is promoted, dismissed with rationale, or recorded as a limitation.
- **Export both views.** Preserve the machine-readable case file and the human-readable report.
- **Transfer securely.** Use the client's approved channel and document receipt, retention, and deletion expectations.
- **Back up before upgrade.** Keep an export outside the application data directory before changing workstation state.

Final review

Can a reviewer identify who acted, under whose authority, against which exact destination, with which tool and settings, what was observed, why the conclusion follows, and how recovery or remediation was verified? If not, the case is not finished.

The operator card

BEFORE

Identity - permit - time - target - port - resolution - policy - objective - observers - abort - evidence

DURING

Watch destination - output - RPS - p95 - errors - saturation - dropped work - communications - stop conditions

AFTER

Recovery - capture - digest - receipt - finding - retest - case export - report - transfer - scope closure

Field shortcuts

IF YOU NEED	DO THIS
A quick answer	Run one focused diagnostic
A repeatable picture	Establish and repeat a complete baseline
Many approved targets	Use a campaign with one objective
Specialist tooling	Export signed scope and import structured evidence
Real load evidence	Verify target capacity and use managed k6
A client decision	Promote evidence into a finding and retest

The standard. Authorized. Attributable. Reproducible.